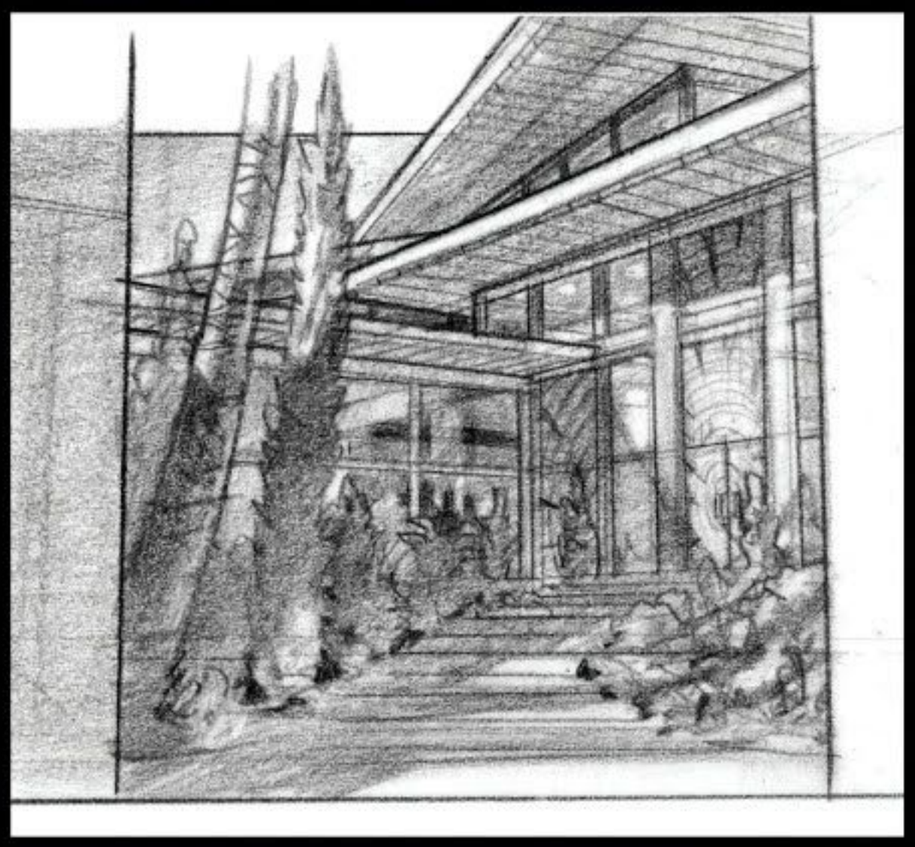




In their early location discussions, Riva and concept artist Phil Saunders had settled on the environs of the Stark Estate: Point Dume, a protected peninsula north of Los Angeles that offered the kind of unique vistas and grand heights that speak to the wealth and power of a man like Tony Stark. Building up to a towering cliff as it thrusts out over the water, Point Dume was an expansive plot of land that would give the Stark Estate both privacy and an uncommon individuality.

But after determining the location, there was the matter of designing the house that would sit upon this evocative landscape. These early sketches of the Stark Estate by Phil Saunders (page 110-111) played off Riva's inspirations from renowned California architect John Lautner.

RIVA: "I'm a big fan of Lautner; I've been influenced by his sensibilities in many films I've done. With this design, I was playing with the notion of a more angular structure, full of triangular and rectangular aspects, and Phil elaborated on that in his sketches. We also had a long driveway that we eventually used in a deleted scene. But there didn't seem to be a focused, core piece to the house, so I started going back to the idea of a huge, rounded, windowed place."